

SAY GOODBYE TO YOUR *BAI*, THANKS TO A **CLEANING ROBOT!**

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How many times have you been worried when your cleaning lady (*bai*, in Hindi language) took a leave without informing you? Or when she was not on time? No matter who does it, cleaning floors manually is tedious and time-consuming.

Nowadays, robots are commonly seen everywhere from homes to offices. Smart cleaning robots make our lives easier by autonomously performing one or more cleaning operations, like vacuuming, dry/wet/damp mopping, etc, efficiently wherever and whenever we want without much human effort.

The rear end of such devices usually includes a bin for dirt and dust collection, while the tank is used for storing water and cleaning solution. Some models come with smart sensors, voice or app control.

Factors to consider

Before making a choice, you should know the key parameters for comparison. Here are a few pointers to help you choose the perfect cleaner for your home that meets your needs.

Type of cleaning. Different floor surfaces like wooden, vinyl and tile have different cleaning requirements. Hence, it is important to think about the kind of floors and areas you will be using the robot on before selecting one. Prefer the one with multiple clean-



Ecovacs Deebot 500
Price: ₹ 14,900



ILIFE V80
Price: ₹ 24,700



iRobot Roomba i7 (i7156)
Price: ₹ 71,000



Robosys KRS 310
Price: ₹ 17,500



Eufy Robovac 11C
Price: ₹ 15,999

ing modes, besides the regular auto mode. For instance, if your living room has a carpet, you will need vacuuming option to remove dust and other particles.

Efficiency of dust removal depends on the filter. Some models can detect the floor type automatically and also offer cleaning for tough stains.

Battery. You would not want to keep charging the bot every now and then while cleaning. Check the battery life and capacity, and see if it is enough for the size of your home. Most bots come with AA (50.5mm x 14.5mm) batteries. Some come with auto-charging feature that allows unaided charging when the batteries reach a certain threshold. For example, 2200mAh battery works for about two hours after its fully charged for four to five hours.

Navigation, scheduling and controls. Cleaners use infrared (IR) signals to know the size of the target room before moving. Sensors allow them to move autonomously, avoiding obstacles or walls for effective cleaning. You can alter the settings and controls using buttons or touch display on the machine. Select one with remote-

control option to control the mopping mechanism from a distance. Without this feature, the cleaner will have to be manually placed everywhere.

Many bots come with programmed scheduling feature, which allows you to set a cleaning schedule even remotely, to let the bot automatically clean at any time and day based on your convenience. You can also choose a cleaning pattern based on the room.

If the bot has Wi-fi connectivity, you can use an app on your phone for control. You will get notifications about the entire process and also about the issues encountered while mopping.

Other features include voice control and integration with other smart home devices.

Build. Size of the bot matters since it has to reach the farthest corners of your house. Small diameter and short height are preferable if there are a lot of obstacles in the room. Whereas, if there is enough space, larger ones will be useful for faster cleaning.

Noise. Some cleaners are loud,